



Rusty's Report

In this issue:

Wildlife Photography by TaintedSorrow pg 2

A Note from the Mods pg 4

The Ship of Dreams, Minecraft Style by LadyKB pg 5

Titancraft Tubings: The Collection by Coccolithophor pg 6

Please submit art!

Another month of my Tangos! Please don't make me use these for another newsletter... Send art!

-be_loved

Dungeon Master Tango

Regular Tango

Please submit art!

Wildlife Photography

An article by Professor Foxfur, resident of RomanEmpire’s city
(Written by TaintedSorrow)

I was watching the sunset over the ocean from the cape, near the lighthouse that had just been remodeled. And as the light turned the fields golden and the shadows stretched from the forest, I was thinking about the urge to get out, away from the hustle and bustle of moving to a new city. How often do we take a step back to appreciate the landscape and natural environment?



To that end, I immediately packed my bags, booked a flight, and departed to unknown biomes, camera in hand....

And what better place to experience the dichotomy between manmade and natural than the harsh, unforgiving badlands, a land almost alien to the familiar mechanized world?



Roaming the red, sun-baked sand, is the small, three-banded armadillo. These little guys are the natural enemy to spiders, making the badlands safe from at least one mob at night and the armadillo a natural companion to miners venturing down into abandoned mineshafts that riddle the biome.



Three-banded armadillos are also the only armadillo species that can curl into a perfectly square ball!

As I was observing this armadillo colony, I turned around, and there on the shore, was a sight so unexpected, I almost couldn't realize what I was seeing! With an inverted palette that looked like a black skeleton against the harsh sand, was what some say is the rarest canine on the planet: the striped wolf.

There was only one.



The snowy wolf is often thought to hold that designation, but a desertifying environment and habitat loss make the striped wolf's native wooded badlands a vanishing biome. In fact, there was not a tree in sight, indicating that this solo individual had traveled far in search of prey, finding it among this plentiful armadillo population.

But armadillos being the armored prey that they are, this fellow had taken to chasing the local desert chickens in search of a meal.

I followed him for several days, and although he was aware of my presence, he didn't seem to think I was a threat. Photography was another matter - unlike the slow armadillos, he never sat still for long; no sooner had he settled and I steadied my camera, he would be off and running, as if he wanted to remain an enigmatic grey ghost.





These final shots of him before I departed really capture the loneliness and harshness of the landscape - the dry ground, the beating sun.

I call the last photo the one that got away. What otherwise would have been perfect is just slightly out of focus! The trials of wildlife photography!

Retreating underground to get out of the sun, it's possible to find lush caverns, abandoned by the ancient miners. In the crystal-clear waters that collect here among eroded clay beds, axolotls, a type of salamander, swim under the dim light of glow berries.



These amphibians are highly playful and love swimming up and down natural waterfalls. But their curiosity can come with a price - lava falls are also common down below, and when the axolotls' playing gets too close... I saw several unlucky individuals meet an untimely end. Although they can regenerate, it can't save them from a near instant fiery death!

Exiting the beautiful but dangerous depths, I made my way to the distant jungle, pursuing the elusive panda.



After many days and nights, I came across a small family group, living at the edge of a bamboo grove. The small cub was barely the height of the wild grass, and as rambunctious as any newborn animal living without fear could be, only returning to its parents' side at nightfall. Away from the lights of any civilization, the darkness of night was nearly complete, making low-light photos especially haunting.



This final photo came as I was packing up to exit the jungle - I turned around and there, at the horizon, was a woodland mansion. Snagging the image of the panda cub and its parent seemingly looking out over at it is a poignant reminder of the effect the Illagers have had on our world as they strip the environment of resources, always looking to gain more.

But as I departed, I had a very close call...

I wasn't even sure how I captured this photo, I was trying to remain unseen, but to no avail! I discovered it upon looking back at my camera roll in the city. I must have snapped it while I was flailing about. How are these things even animated? Remains of ancient miners? A veritable ghost in the shell. Best to keep your wits about – even in the daylight, the jungle is full of surprises!

That's all I had time for in this expedition, but there's always more sights to see, more biomes to explore and new animal behaviors to uncover!





A Note from the Mods:

- Easter Stream
 - The Easter District will be shown off on stream by CptCuddlefish on the April 4, 2026! This will also include the aforementioned egg hunt and egg decorating events! Feel free to paint practice eggs at the spawn portal tower.
- At the end of last year we announced we were looking for submissions for next season's nether hub. Since we want to select the design well ahead of the new season in order to give the builder enough time to organize themselves and implement potential changes, we'll be closing the submission window soon.
 - The deadline for any new submissions or updates to new submissions will be on Easter, the 5th of April.

The Ship of Dreams, Minecraft Style

by LadyKB

Long before the start of Season 10 of Titancraft, Wrathofthefrog planned a build of “Titanic” proportions for the new season on the horizon. Known for building grand ships of old, Wrath had already had his work cut out for him when he set his mind for one of the grandest, but most tragic, ocean liners of the 20th century. He also knew that the RMS Titanic would be hard for a Titan to build alone. I had the same thought when Wrath came to me with his idea. Having had a “small” obsession with the Titanic myself since the movie debut in 1997, I eagerly jumped at the chance to aid in the planning and hopefully some of the building process. Little did Wrath realize how exactly not small that obsession was. An obsession that had only increased with not only one of my favorite video games, but also with my first ever cruise at the end of February.



It was early in the morning of April 15, 1912 when RMS Titanic disappeared into the waters of the Northern Atlantic on her maiden voyage. It only took 2 hours and 40 minutes for the largest vessel of her time to sink below the waves after striking an iceberg and taking the lives of 1635 out of the 2224 people on board. A lot of the disaster can be attributed towards poor evacuation planning & lack of a sufficient number of lifeboats. Ironically, an evacuation (muster) drill was planned to occur on the day of the sinking. Also, the Titanic had more of the required number of lifeboats at the time of its sailing. It is because of this tragedy that all cruises now must have their muster drills done prior to leaving port and have enough lifeboats for everyone on board.



With that out of the way, let us talk about our own ship that I lovingly call, the Titancraftanic. Copyright infringement avoidance aside, this ocean liner is built on a 4:1 ratio scale. Something, that Wrath had to point out because the Titanic that was built on Skizzlecrafter is a 1:1 scale model. If people are wondering, yes that means our ship is bigger. With a multitude of resources, undertaking this task relied on the talent of MANY other Titans as well. On more than enough occasions, the Discord channel had rung the call for things like wool, diorite, and quartz...a lot of quartz. Like the amazing people we are, the call was answered in a multitude of fashion. Thank-you all for your help!



While the journey to completion still feels like it is a long way off (but closer than you think!), it was filled with a multitude of memories along the way. Such memories include the moving of the build site! Did you know that the Titancraftanic was originally to be placed near an ice field down the Southern tunnel? However, because it was

deemed to possibly be too close to our holiday districts, the mods & staff kindly asked the project to be moved. With their help, we were able to find a good location near the lovely mooshroom island down the Eastern tunnel by banner 13. I like to think of it as their worry that this ship would succumb to the same tragic fate as its namesake near that ice field. Not that Caable hasn't insisted he'd try to do so anyways. His plan for him trying to be the iceberg can be located near the forward starboard (front right) of the ship. It was a joy with the trial & error it took to making him look frozen in ice without it melting.



Another great memory was the was watching as water was removed from the hull. Ghandi, Kafoot, & Matter were part of the team who helped do so. Laughs were shared all around as everyone worked to replace blocks that were pushed and light up the area as needed. I even kept yelling at them when it came to the debris in “my ocean” as it went on.

As things moved on though, people joined the building process that we want to highlight. BO soon joined the building process after the start and before you knew it, a tug boat filled with masons and the Grand Staircase was built. Izeman joined the build as well when he took breaks from helping with the Slime Farm dig. With the completion of the Alice project, Aliyar traveled over and helped with a majority of the build once Wrath & I needed a break with Minty also helping build & grinding down diorite for our need of quartz.



Despite everyone's best efforts, we will be sad to announce that it won't fully be decorated inside as intended. But do not let this news dampen all the accomplishments that have been done. There is still so much to look at around this beauty of a build. And there is still a lot of minor “easter eggs” also to be found around the ship. From a hidden duck to tie ins with the game “Titanic: Adventure out of Time” I hope you are able to find them all.

I also ask that everyone be on the look out for your mailboxes. A mass mailing will be coming soon for a book called “Futility”. History buffs will know that this book came out 14 years before the famous disaster. Some believe that because of the plot's similarities to the tragedy, that it was a prophecy in the making. After the sinking, “Futility” was reissued to be titled “The Wreck of the Titan” and some details were adjusted accordingly. This would be probably my most favorite of the special details provided.



Please, everyone feel free to visit us down in Eastern tunnel. We will be happy to show off everything we can. Thank you once again to everyone who joined us on this journey. Much love, and I promise this “Ship of Titancraft Dreams” truly is “unsinkable.”

Titancraft Tubing

By Coccolithophor

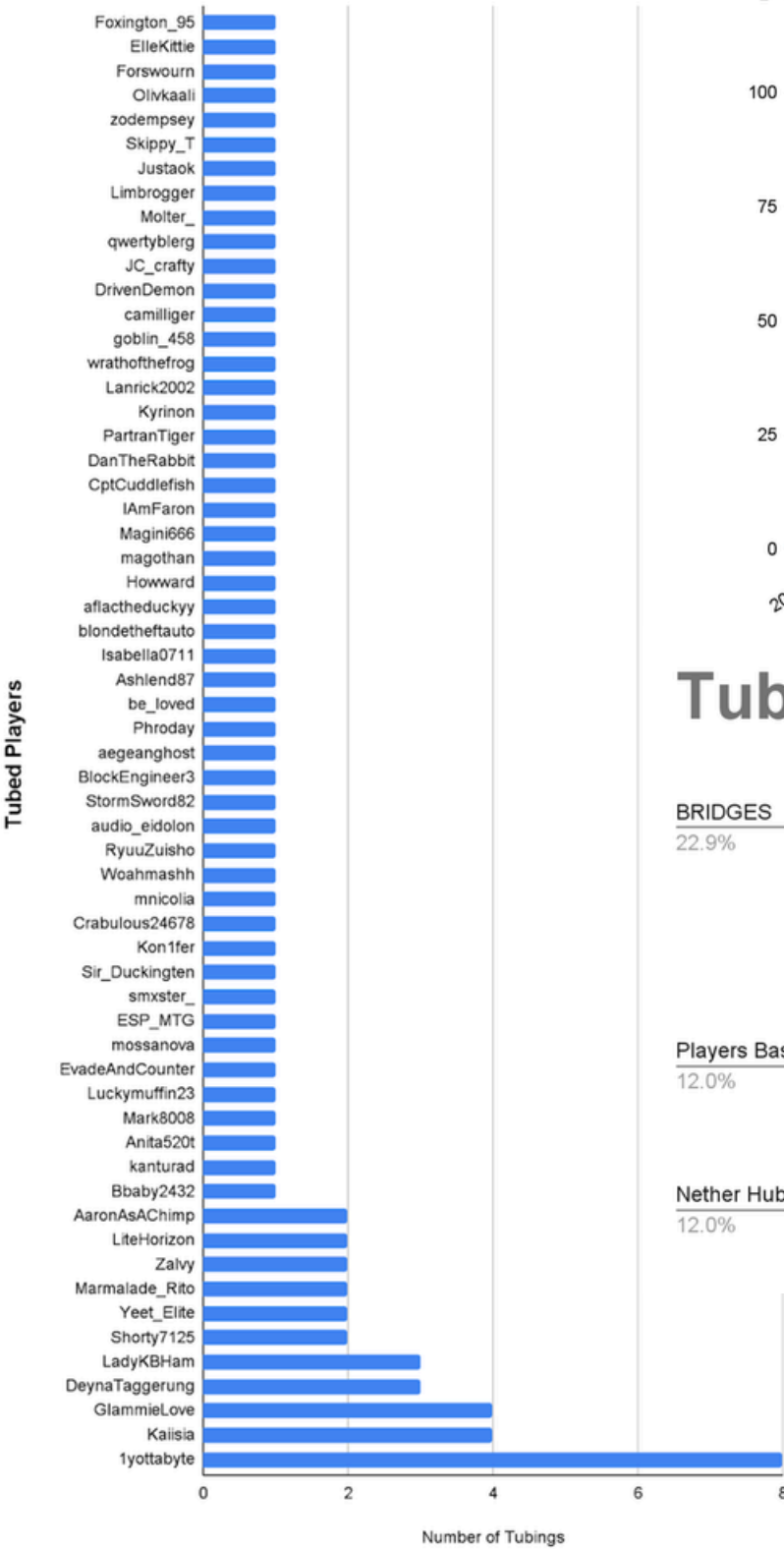
Starting this season, for one reason or another, I began “Tubing” players that were standing still (not necessarily afk) in glass panes. I then started taking screenshots of the tubings. Now that the season is wrapping up, I figured I would make use of all 83 tubings and have some fun. Enjoy!

(Bonus Points if you can find yourself! Unless you are yotta)

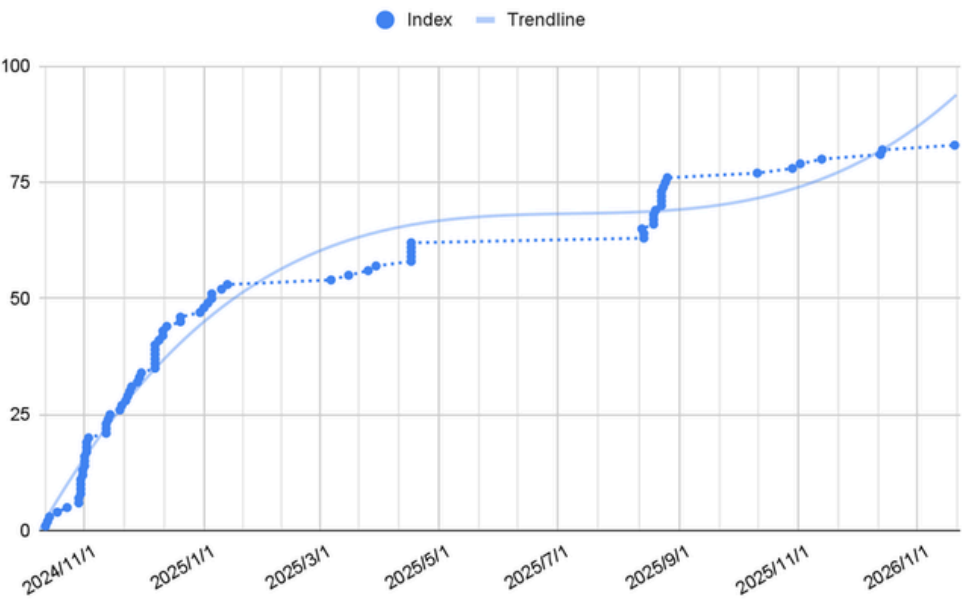


Tubings: The Graphs

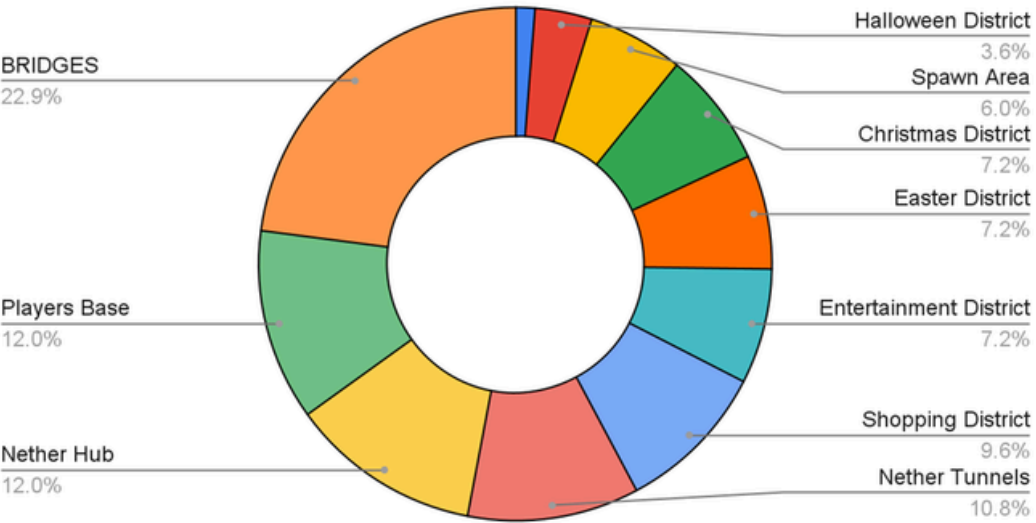
Tubings per Player



Tubings Over Time



Tubings Per Location



Thank you all so much for dealing with my shenanigans all this time!
Let's hope for a great next season!

~ Coccolithophor